

Measured voice from Southie atop ICE

Lyons's style differs from more bellicose president

By Emma Platoff
and Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio
GLOBE STAFF

As head of Immigration and Customs Enforcement, Todd Lyons has a particular preference for members of his security detail: agents without children.

Working in Washington while his family lives in Massachusetts, Lyons knows what it's like to miss Thanksgiving together or a kid's football game.

"He didn't want to take guys away from their children," said his uncle, Jack Lyons.

Yet the agency he oversees often breaks up families in its controversial campaign to fulfill President Trump's mandate for the mass deportation of undocumented immigrants. Since his appointment last March, hundreds of thousands of people have been detained and deported from the United States, many leaving families behind.

This is but one seeming contradiction at play with the 52-year-old Lyons, a native of Southie, career law enforcement official, and Air Force veteran who has worked at ICE nearly since the agency's infancy two decades ago. Affable and even-keeled, a self-described "football and baseball dad," Lyons supervises an army of armed

LYONS, Page A8

On campus, a muted student protest scene

Restrictions, threats spur other outlets for anger

By Hilary Burns
GLOBE STAFF
and Lila Hempel-Edgers
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Donald Trump promised to stamp out the raucous mass protests of college students that disrupted so many campuses in 2024 when he campaigned for president a second time.

So far, he appears to have done so. And, apparently, with help from the colleges themselves.

Two years after pro-Palestinian encampments bloomed on college greens to protest the Israeli campaign against Gaza, Harvard Yard, the quad at Northeastern, and other campus gathering spots are largely void of demonstrators while the United States and Israel wage war in the Middle East.

Indeed, in a time seemingly loaded with things for young people to be angry about, the noisy coming together of college students in mass demonstration is pretty hard to find on campuses.

"I find it kind of insane that there is no huge

PROTESTS, Page A10



Amid vaunted health care, gaps in delivery

Above, Brianna Smith-Thomson, a mother of three girls, said the loss of follow-up care can be devastating. At right, Erin Yang had hoped to avoid a C-section.



PHOTOS BY JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

By many measures, maternal health in the state has gotten worse over time, not better

By Sarah Rahal
GLOBE STAFF

For all the money and glory associated with the Massachusetts medical world, one of the oldest and most fundamental aspects of it is going in the wrong direction: giving birth.

Maternity units and birthing centers are closing. Too many low-risk pregnancies end up with deliveries by C-section, and too many patients, especially women of color, have disproportionately high numbers of complications and adverse outcomes.

Dr. Wendy Barr, a family physician who provides pregnancy care and conducts research, said maternal health too often receives intensive medical or surgical treatment.

"In the urban Northeast, we're very good at caring for the sick and finding cures for acute rare diseases, and because we do that so well, we use a very specialized disease-oriented approach and apply it to the birth process, which does better with a holistic approach," said Barr, who practiced in Massachusetts for 15 years and now helps run a family medicine residency at Yale School of Medicine.

Severe maternal complications among Massachusetts births are 16 percent higher than the national average and the rate nearly doubled between 2011 and 2020. Racial

MATERNAL HEALTH, Page A12

Hard lesson in promises that were too good to be true

Behind the appealing facade, founder of Croft School couldn't make it work

By John Hilliard
and Mike Damiano
GLOBE STAFF

To many parents, the Croft School seemed like a miracle: small classes and devoted teachers. A curriculum that mixed academic rigor with "social-emotional learning."

Concierge-like services including a curbside dropoff option so parents could quickly leave their children and zip off to work.

Parents believed it would be a pillar of their children's future. "My wife and I, we just can't imagine sending our son anywhere else for

school," said Gustavo Quiroga, whose son is enrolled in Croft's pre-kindergarten program.

For progressive, white-collar parents, Croft — with locations in Jamaica Plain, the South End, and Providence — offered a private alternative to public schools that was still aligned with their values. Scott Given, a well-regarded education entrepreneur and Croft's founder, billed the school as a "diverse, inclusive,

anti-racist community."

What's more, the price was right. Tuition was thousands less than top-flight private schools — and Given was known to offer steep discounts to families of more modest means.

What Given had created seemed almost too good to be true: a private school without exorbitant costs or moral compromises. And somehow he had managed to do it for a frac-

CROFT SCHOOL, Page A11

Puzzle box TV series thrive on disorientation — and make for great streaming, writes Chris Vognar, as he offers his list of 10 to watch. **SundayArts, N1.**

The last-second 3-pointer by UConn's Braylon Mullins is the



kind of shot that reminds fans why they love sports, writes Dan Shaughnessy. **Sports, C1.**

The Globe Magazine is not publishing this week. The puzzles can be found on B8.

Caught in a splash mob

Sunday: Rainy, windy. High: 58-63. Low: 38-43.

Monday: Clouds, sun. High: 50-55. Low: 34-39.

Sunrise: 6:20 Sunset: 7:14

Complete report, **C24.**

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